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WAM

UAE TAKES CENTRE STAGE AT ASIAN GAMES

The 20th Asian Games officially opened in Nagoya, Japan, on Saturday, with the UAE taking centre stage as its 165-member delegation joined athletes and teams from across Asia at the start of the 16-day continental sporting event. The Games, which runs until October 4, will see 117 men and 48 women from the UAE competing across 21 sports and disciplines and hoping to add to the tally of 60 medals — 12 gold, 21 silver and 27 bronze. **SEE ALSO P15**

UAE advances peace through mediation, humanitarian action

Efforts in Ukraine, Gaza, Sudan reflect nation's support for peace and stability

ABU DHABI

As the world marks the International Day of Peace today, the UAE continues to advance efforts in support of peace and stability through dialogue, diplomacy, humanitarian action and international cooperation, based on an approach that places conflict prevention, confidence-building and the protection of civilians alongside efforts to resolve existing crises.

Ukraine prisoner exchanges

Amid the Ukraine crisis, the UAE announced the success of a new mediation effort that resulted in the exchange of 206 captives, with 103 released from each side in August. The ex-

change brought the total number of captives released through 26 UAE mediation efforts since the outbreak of the crisis to 7,997. The UAE also hosted two rounds of trilateral talks between the United States, Russia and Ukraine in Abu Dhabi in January and February.

\$500 million to Sudan

At the US Donors' Conference for Sudan in February, the UAE pledged \$500 million to address urgent humanitarian needs arising from the conflict. This came alongside humanitarian assistance exceeding \$800 million provided by the UAE since the outbreak of the crisis in 2023.

Gaza humanitarian efforts

In Gaza, the UAE has continued political and humanitarian efforts focused on protecting civilians, facilitating aid delivery and supporting a political process leading to a just and lasting peace. President His Highness

Sheikh Mohamed Bin Zayed Al Nahyan accepted an invitation for the UAE to join the Board of Peace in January as part of efforts supporting implementation of the Comprehensive Plan to End the Gaza Conflict.

At the Board of Peace's inaugural meeting in February, the UAE announced an additional \$1.2 billion to support Gaza.

UAE aid delivered through Operation Gallant Knight 3 has exceeded \$3.89 billion and included more than 126,000 tonnes of relief, medical and food supplies. UAE hospitals and medical facilities supporting Palestinians had also provided treatment to more than 230,000 patients.

Together, these initiatives reflect the UAE's continued use of diplomatic engagement, mediation, humanitarian assistance and institutional partnerships in support of international peace and stability. — WAM

SEE ALSO P4,10

Dubai's Atlantis The Royal 4th among 50 best hotels

Hotel also picks up two top awards globally

DUBAI

BY SURABHI
VASUNDHARADEVI
Social Media Reporter

Dubai's Atlantis The Royal has reached its highest ranking yet, climbing to fourth place on The 50 Best Hotels 2026 list just three years after making its debut on the ranking. The hotel also picked up two special awards this year, Best Hotel in the Middle East 2026 and Best Beach Hotel 2026, according to its official listing on The 50 Best Hotels website.

The result caps a steady climb up the list. Atlantis

The Royal entered at No 44 in 2023, moved to No 9 in 2024, reached No 6 in 2025, and has now landed at No 4. The hotel sits on Crescent Road on Palm Jumeirah and has 795 rooms and suites, including 44 penthouses with private glass-sided pools.



Rosewood Hong Kong retained the No 1 spot for a second consecutive year. Capella Bangkok placed second and Four Seasons Bangkok at Chao Phraya River placed third.

Dubai had a second hotel in the global top 15. Jumeirah Marsa Al Arab rose five places to No 15, up from No 20 in its debut year in 2025.

HOUTHIS TARGETING RIYADH RAISES REGIONAL ALARM

Trump cuts short Camp David stay as US warns of escalation

DUBAI

BY STEPHEN N. R.
Senior Associate Editor

Alarm is growing across the region after Yemen's Iran-backed Houthi militants targeted Riyadh for the first time since the conflict resumed, pushing the Saudi-Houthi confrontation across a new threshold as Washington warned that fighting could "escalate rapidly".

Saudi Arabia said its air defences intercepted and destroyed a Houthi ballistic missile targeting the capital on Saturday. Loud explosions were heard in Riyadh and a fuel tank bearing the Aramco logo caught fire near King Khalid International Airport. The Houthis also claimed attacks on Aramco facilities in Yanbu.

Rapid offensive

The strikes come as the Iran-backed group presses a rapid offensive inside Yemen, seizing strategic territory along the Red Sea coast and increasing pressure on Saudi Arabia. The US State Department warned that the conflict had the potential to "escalate rapidly" and urged Americans outside the Middle East to seriously reconsider travel to and through the region.

US President Donald Trump,

meanwhile, unexpectedly cut short his weekend at Camp David and returned to the White House on Saturday. Trump later told Fox News that Washington remained in "constant communication" with the Houthis and said the group had agreed not to fight the United States.

Saudi Arabia has carried out scores of airstrikes during the latest Houthi offensive, but has so far failed to halt the group's advance inside Yemen. Its capture of territory along the Red Sea has also heightened concerns over shipping through the Bab Al Mandab, already increasingly important as the Strait of Hormuz remains blockaded.

UAE-India talks

Amid the escalating regional tensions, UAE President His Highness Sheikh Mohamed Bin Zayed Al Nahyan and Indian Prime Minister Narendra Modi discussed efforts to strengthen regional security and stability during a phone call on Friday.

Qatar's Prime Minister Sheikh Mohammed Bin Abdulrahman Al Thani said the region had experienced an "earthquake" in recent months, putting assumptions about security and stability to a severe test. Turkey has also said it has discussed possible assistance to Saudi Arabia as tensions rise.

SEE ALSO P6

TELL ME WHY

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